

YOUR \$1,000-A-MONTH FUNNEL

A Practical Playbook for Jessica Alvarez, Benefit Specialist
Premier Financial Alliance • National Life Group — Living Benefits

The honest truth first: \$1,000 a month in life insurance is not a salary and it is not passive at the start. It is commission from policies that are **submitted, issued, delivered, and still in force**. You do not need hundreds of people. At a typical starting contract, you need about **2–3 placed policies a month** — every month. Miss a month of activity and the next month's income disappears. This playbook shows the math, the funnel that produces those 4 policies, what to stop doing, and the exact words to use.

Your real advantage

Most new PFA agents cold-call strangers with a product. You already have what they are trying to buy: **trust**. For five years you have helped special-needs families with SSI/SSDI, medication assistance, and the transition to 18 in San Antonio and across Texas, in English and Spanish. Those parents are the most under-insured families in America — if a parent dies or gets cancer, everything they built for their child is at risk. Start there. Strangers are step 10, not step 1.

Your product edge — say it correctly

From your training and the National Life Group (LSW) Living Benefits brochure you shared:

- **National Life Group: 90 Comdex rating** in your training comparison (Transamerica 84, Corebridge 87, F&G; 79). Comdex is a composite of rating agencies — a strength indicator, not a guarantee.
- **18 qualifying Living Benefits events** in that comparison — 13 critical illnesses, 4 critical injuries, plus Alzheimer's / Lewy Body triggers — versus 10–13 events for the other carriers shown.
- **4 triggers:** Terminal Illness, Chronic Illness (can't do 2 of 6 Activities of Daily Living or severe cognitive impairment for 90 days), Critical Illness, and Critical Injury — plus the death benefit itself.
- **Real claim from your training:** a 38-year-old full-time nurse and mom of 3, policy issued Dec. 1, 2021, diagnosed with stage-3 breast cancer 4 months later. Her \$501,003.10 death benefit accelerated to an estimated **\$425,298** payment. Notice the lesson: acceleration pays on a **discounted basis** — it is not dollar-for-dollar, and it reduces or ends the remaining benefit. Always say that out loud.
- Living Benefits riders are included at **no additional cost** on the NLG policies described in the brochure, but receipt of accelerated benefits may be taxable and may affect eligibility for public assistance programs — a point that matters enormously for your SSI families (see page 4).

1 THE MATH — HOW MANY SALES = \$1,000?

Read this before you use any number: PFA pay depends on YOUR contract level, the carrier and product, the policy's *target* premium on an IUL (not the whole deposit), advance vs. as-earned, and chargebacks if a policy lapses. The tables below use **your confirmed 45% rate** (confirmed by you on 2026-10-05). Your advance percentage and any product-specific differences still come from your PFA compensation schedule — check it before quoting these figures to a recruit.

Term with Living Benefits — at your 45% of first-year premium

Client pays	Annual premium	You earn per placed policy	Placed sales for \$1,000
\$60 / month	\$720	\$324	4 sales (3 = \$972)
\$80 / month	\$960	\$432	3 sales (2 = \$864)
\$100 / month	\$1,200	\$540	2 sales
\$125 / month	\$1,500	\$675	2 sales (1 = \$675)

Indexed Universal Life (IUL) — at your 45% of target premium only

Client pays	Annual target premium	You earn per placed policy	Placed sales for \$1,000
\$100 / month	\$1,200	\$540	2 sales
\$150 / month	\$1,800	\$810	2 sales (1 = \$810)
\$200 / month	\$2,400	\$1,080	1 sale
\$250 / month	\$3,000	\$1,350	1 sale
\$300 / month	\$3,600	\$1,620	1 sale

The mix that hits \$1,000 most reliably for you

- **Plan A (simplest):** 1 IUL at \$150/mo + 1 Term at \$80/mo = \$810 + \$432 = **\$1,242** — two families, goal cleared in gross first-year commission before advance % / chargebacks.
- **Plan B (term-heavy, younger families):** 3 Term at \$80–\$100/mo = **\$1,296–\$1,620**. And 2 Term at \$100/mo alone = \$1,080.
- **Plan C (one strong IUL case):** 1 IUL at \$200/mo = **\$1,080**, or 1 IUL at \$250/mo = **\$1,350** — great month, dangerous plan. One declined or lapsed case = \$0. Never build your month on one family.
- **Build in loss:** not every application issues, and not every issued policy stays. If about 3 of 4 place and persist, you must **submit 4 applications to keep 3**. The funnel below still targets 6 submissions and 4–5 placed — at 45% that is roughly \$1,700–\$2,000+, so one decline or chargeback does not kill your month.
- **Renewals are the long game:** small renewal commissions in years 2+ are how \$1,000 of *new* work becomes steadier monthly income over time. Protect them: deliver every policy in person/Zoom, do an annual review, and never let a client lapse without a call.

Working backwards — the activity funnel

Stage	Monthly target	Weekly target
Names on your list (Project 100+)	200+ names, always adding	Add 10 new names
Real conversations / touches	80–100	20–25
Appointments booked	30	7–8
Appointments held (Zooms)	18–20	5
Fact-finds + illustrations shown	12	3
Applications submitted	6	1–2
Policies placed & delivered	4–5	1

If your numbers are lower than this at any stage, the problem is almost never your closing. It is the stage above it. Fix the stage above.

2 WHAT YOU'RE DOING WRONG — AND THE FIX

These are the patterns in almost every new PFA agent who stays under \$1,000 — check yourself honestly against each one:

- 1 Leading with features instead of the family's problem.** Comdex scores, '18 triggers,' and product-vs-service slides are agent training. Families don't buy triggers. They buy: 'If I get cancer like that nurse did, my mortgage and my kids are covered while I'm alive.' *Fix:* problem → story → solution → product, in that order.
- 2 Repeating training claims that can cost you your license.** Your slides say 8%–10%, 'tax free,' 'penalty free,' and compare against banks. Said to a client as a promise, that is misrepresentation. An IUL's credited rate is capped, can be 0% in a flat year, and is **not guaranteed**; loans are only tax-advantaged while the policy stays in force and can lapse if over-borrowed. *Fix:* use only the signed NLG illustration and approved brochure language, and say 'illustrated, not guaranteed' every time.
- 3 Sharing training material publicly.** Every screenshot you sent is marked 'For Agents Training Only. Not for Public Distribution.' Posting them is a compliance violation. *Fix:* clients only ever see carrier-approved consumer pieces like the LSW Living Benefits brochure (TC8751580).
- 4 Cold-calling strangers first while your warm market sits untouched.** You help families every week through Southern Oak. *Fix:* Project 100 first — family, friends, past SSA/medication clients (with permission), churches, clinics, teachers, special-needs parents.
- 5 Pitching instead of booking.** A driveway or phone pitch gets a 'no.' A booked 30-minute Zoom gets a fact-find. *Fix:* every conversation has one goal only — book the Zoom. Your quote intake page already asks morning / afternoon / evening. Use it.
- 6 No follow-up system.** Most policies sell on touches 3–7. Without a cadence — day 1, 3, 7, 14, 30 — your 'maybe later' people are gone. *Fix:* the cadence on page 4. No lead leaves the list without a next date.
- 7 Recruiting before producing.** People join producers. Your own 5 sales in 30 days is your recruiting proof. *Fix:* personal production first, invite second — and invite clients who saw the product work, not random contacts.
- 8 Same recommendation for everyone.** Term fits a young family protecting income on a budget. An IUL fits a client with stable extra cash flow, a long horizon, and a real permanent need — after suitability, funding level, and costs are explained. Undersold, underfunded IULs lapse and charge back. *Fix:* needs analysis (DIME: Debt, Income × years, Mortgage, Education) on every case.
- 9 No daily scoreboard.** If you can't say today's conversations, bookings, and submissions, you're hoping, not running a funnel. *Fix:* track the 5 numbers at the bottom of page 4, daily.

3 YOUR FUNNEL — 6 STEPS

- 1 **LIST (Project 100+).** Write 100 names before you judge any of them: family, friends, Southern Oak clients, coworkers from CPG/ABC of Southwest Texas days, church, neighbors, parents from school and therapy waiting rooms. Then add 10 a week, forever.
- 2 **INVITE — free Living Benefits Policy Review.** Your lead offer is not 'buy insurance.' It is: 'A free 30-minute review — do you have the old kind that only pays when you die, or the kind that can pay while you're alive?' Send them to your Southern Oak quote intake form to pick a time window.
- 3 **DISCOVER (30-min Zoom).** Fact-find only: income, debts, mortgage, kids, existing coverage (most work policies are 1–2× salary and end when the job ends), health, and — for your families — who cares for their child if they can't.
- 4 **ILLUSTRATE.** Show the NLG illustration, the Living Benefits brochure, and the nurse's story. State the discount on acceleration, the caps and costs on an IUL, and what is *not* guaranteed. Invite your upline/field trainer to your first 5 presentations.
- 5 **APPLY + PLACE.** E-application the same day, set expectations for underwriting, stay in contact until issue, then **deliver the policy** and explain it page by page. Delivery is where referrals happen.
- 6 **ASK — referrals and the opportunity.** Every delivered client hears two questions: 'Who are the 3 people you love most who still have the old kind of policy?' and, only when it fits, 'Would you like to see how you could do what I do, part-time?'

Your special-needs edge — and your duty

For families receiving SSI/Medicaid, **how** a policy is owned and who is named beneficiary can affect benefits. Cash value owned by the child, or a death benefit paid directly to a young adult on SSI, can create a resource problem. Never structure that on your own — coordinate with a special-needs trust / qualified attorney, disclose that accelerated benefits may affect public-assistance eligibility (the NLG brochure says exactly this), and document the conversation. Agents who protect a family's benefits while protecting their income are the agents families keep for life. That is how you become a *good* agent, not just a producing one.

Follow-up cadence — copy this

When	Touch
Day 1	Thank-you text + brochure PDF after the first conversation
Day 3	Nurse's story (approved brochure) + 'did you get a chance to look?'
Day 7	Short voice note: answer the one question they asked
Day 14	Invite again to a specific time: 'Tuesday 10 or Thursday 2?'
Day 30	Value touch: Southern Oak SSA / medication tip — stay their advocate
Quarterly	Check-in. Life changes = coverage changes. Never go silent.

Your daily scoreboard (report it to yourself every night)

Conversations ____ | Booked ____ | Held ____ | Illustrations ____ | Applications ____ — Hit 20–25 conversations a week and the \$1,000 math on page 2 takes care of itself.

4 SCRIPTS — SAY IT LIKE THIS

Meeting someone new (30 seconds)

“Hi, I'm Jessica Alvarez with Southern Oak Financial & Wellness here in San Antonio. I help families protect their income with life insurance that can pay them *while they're alive* if they get cancer, a heart attack, or can't care for themselves — not just after they pass. Most families I meet only have the old kind. Can I ask — do you know which kind you have?” Then stop talking. Listen. Book the review.

Family & friends (warm call or text)

“Hey [Name], I'm expanding the life insurance side of Southern Oak, and I'm practicing my new Living Benefits review with people I trust before I take it to the public. It's 30 minutes on Zoom, there's no charge and no pressure to buy anything — I just need honest feedback, and you might actually learn whether your policy would pay while you're alive. Would [morning / afternoon / evening] this week work better for you?”

Cold call (keep it short — the goal is the appointment, not the sale)

“Hi [Name], this is Jessica Alvarez, a local benefit specialist in San Antonio. I help families review whether their life insurance includes Living Benefits — the kind that can pay part of the benefit while you're alive after a major illness. A lot of families here don't know they have the old kind. I'm offering a free 30-minute review this week. Would a morning or an afternoon time work better?” If 'not interested': “Totally fine — can I ask, do you already have coverage outside of work?” One question often re-opens it. If still no: thank them, log it, move on.

For a special-needs parent (your voice, your community)

“You and I have worked on [your child's benefits / medication]. Can I ask you something separate? If something happened to *you* — an illness where you couldn't work for six months — what happens to everything we've set up for [child]? That's exactly what I help parents review now. No charge, 30 minutes, and I'll be careful about anything that could affect benefits. Can we look at it together this week?”

Handling the 4 objections you will hear most

- **“I already have insurance.”** → “That's great — most people I review do too. The review is just checking one thing: does yours pay while you're alive, or only at death? If it already does, I'll tell you to keep it. Fair?”
- **“I have it through work.”** → “Most work coverage is 1–2 times your salary and it usually ends when the job ends — right when health may be the reason you left. Let's just check what you actually have.”
- **“I need to think about it.”** → “Of course. What part do you want to think through — the amount, the monthly cost, or whether it fits your family? Let's name it, and I'll send you exactly that information.” (Never argue. Book the follow-up date before you hang up.)
- **“It's too expensive.”** → “Let's right-size it instead of dropping it. Term with Living Benefits at \$60–\$80 a month protects most young families. What's a monthly number that would feel responsible, not stressful?”

Referral ask (at policy delivery — every time)

“[Name], who are the three people you love most who probably still have the old kind of policy? I'm not going to pitch them — I'll offer them the same free review you got. If they say no, that's the end of it.”

Your 30-day sprint

Week	Focus	Done when
1	Build Project 100 list; 25 conversations; learn the NLG illustration tool; write up 12 Zooms booked	100 leads written up
2	Hold 5 Zooms with field trainer; first illustrations	2 applications submitted
3	Follow-up cadence on every Week 1–2 contact; 25 new conversations	4 applications submitted total
4	Deliver first policies; referral ask at every delivery; invite your happy clients to place 10 potential games	5 applications submitted

Be the agent families describe like N. Chavez described you — “always truly honest and helpful.” Quote only approved illustrations, disclose what's discounted and what isn't guaranteed, put suitability before commission, keep E&O; current, complete Texas replacement forms when you replace a policy, and document every recommendation. Production gets you to \$1,000 once. Honesty is what keeps you there.

Prepared for Jessica Alvarez — Southern Oak Financial & Wellness. All commission math uses your confirmed 45% rate; your advance % and product-specific carrier compensation can still vary, so check your PFA schedule before quoting income figures to anyone, including recruits.